26900392 **Reg.No : .....**

Name : .....

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (Honours)/ MGU-BBA (Honours)/ MGU-BCA (Honours)

REGULAR EXAMINATION October 2026

Fifth SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG5DSCPHL301 - RATIONALISM

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 Hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A

Short Answer

Answer any **8** questions

Each question carries **2** marks

1. Define the principle of clarity and distinctness as applied to mathematical reasoning. [K] / [CO1]
2. State the relationship between thinking and the existence of the mind in Descartes. [K] / [CO2]
3. Identify the essential characteristics of Spinozistic substance. [U] / [CO3]
4. State the meaning of apperception in Leibniz's philosophy. [U] / [CO4]
5. State why the Cogito is regarded as an indubitable truth. [K] / [CO1]
6. Identify the basis of Descartes' argument from the cause of the idea of God. [K] / [CO2]
7. Define mind–body dualism according to René Descartes. [K] / [CO2]
8. Define Spinoza's philosophical conception of substance. [K] / [CO3]
9. State the basic claim of the Identity of Indiscernibles [U] / [CO4]

10. Define the doctrine of pre-established harmony according to Leibniz. [K] / [CO4]

11. State the characteristics of a clear idea in Descartes' criterion of truth. [K] / [CO1]

12. Define mind–body interactionism in Descartes' philosophy. [K] / [CO2]

[2x8 = 16]

Part B

Short Essay

Answer any **6** questions

Each question carries **5** marks

13. Explain the distinction between immediate and mediate modes within the framework of Natura Naturata. [U] / [CO3]

14. Discuss the different grades of perception found among monads [U] / [CO4]

15. Compare thought and extension as the principal attributes of created substances. [U] / [CO2]

16. Explain Descartes' view that innate ideas are discovered through the mind rather than produced by sensory experience. [U] / [CO1]

17. Explain how Deus sive Natura expresses Spinoza's monistic conception of reality. [U] / [CO3]

18. Discuss the role of demonstrations in establishing propositions in Spinoza's method [U] / [CO3]

19. Discuss the transition in Leibniz's thought from scholastic influences to a modern philosophical framework. [U] / [CO4]

20. Explain the correspondence between the order of ideas and the order of bodily events in Spinoza. [U] / [CO3]

21. Discuss the intellectual background of the rise of Rationalism in Modern Philosophy. [U] / [CO1]

22. Discuss the major philosophical aim that shaped Descartes' intellectual journey. [U] / [CO1]

[5x6 = 30]

Part C

Essay

Answer any **2** questions

Each question carries **12** marks

23. Discuss Spinoza's doctrine of intellectual love of God, explaining its origin in adequate and intuitive knowledge. [E] / [CO3]

24. Examine the application of the Law of Sufficient Reason to necessary and contingent truths. Explain how Leibniz distinguishes the grounds of these two types of truths. [U] / [CO4]

25. Examine the different grounds employed by Descartes in his initial scepticism and explain how they lead him toward the rejection of uncertain beliefs [U] / [CO1]

26. Discuss Descartes' theory of substance, explaining the nature and characteristics of infinite substance and finite substances. [U] / [CO2]

[12x2 = 24]